

DGD App Store Readiness

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Verdict

As submitted, this build would be rejected by both Google Play and the Apple App Store, and it cannot be uploaded to either store in its current form. The problems fall into three groups: mechanical packaging (debug build, debug signing key, wrong version, target API below Play's minimum), content (every screen is watermarked "PREVIEW / NOT LIVE / coming soon," which reads as unfinished), and one strategic issue that outranks the rest: this is a cryptocurrency product, not a game, and both stores apply strict crypto rules the project does not yet satisfy. The app is technically clean (Flutter plus Jetpack Compose, minimal permissions, no cleartext, no risky SDKs), so the work is packaging, disclosures, and a positioning decision, not a rebuild.

What the binary is

File reviewed: DGD-merged-arcade-v1.0.2-demo-debug.apk (81 MB). It currently calls one live endpoint, /forms/stats; all other on-screen features are gated behind the preview state and do not transact yet.

Property	Value	Note
Package ID	com.digitalgold.ticker	Code also references co.digitalgold.arcade.module; pick one identity
Version	1.0.0 / code 1	Filename claims v1.0.2; mismatch
Build type	debug (debuggable=true)	Hard blocker
Signing	Android Debug key only	Hard blocker
minSdk / targetSdk	26 / 35	Target must be 36 for Play
Native ABIs	arm64, armeabi-v7a, x86_64 complete; x86 incomplete	Ship an App Bundle and let Play handle it

Property	Value	Note
Permissions	INTERNET, VIBRATE	Clean
Cleartext traffic	Disabled	Good

Mechanical blockers

These stop the upload before any review begins.

1. Debug build. debuggable=true is set; both stores refuse it. Ship a release build with shrinking/obfuscation on.
2. Debug signing key. Certificate is CN=Android Debug. Create a production upload keystore (enroll in Play App Signing) and an Apple Distribution certificate and profile. Back up the keystore; losing it is unrecoverable.
3. targetSdk 35, Play requires 36. As of August 31, 2026, Play requires new apps and updates to target API 36 (Android 16). Bump and retest.
4. APK, not App Bundle. Play requires the .aab format for new apps; this also resolves the incomplete x86 build automatically.
5. Placeholder App Store ID. The binary hardcodes apps.apple.com/app/id0000000000; replace with the real ID before the iOS build ships, or the invite/share flow points to a dead link.

The crypto decision (settle this first)

This determines whether the app is approvable at all. On screen it shows a coin (DGD), a live price of \$11.52, an \$85.7M market cap, growth charts, a "Get Digital Gold" button, a signup wizard that links a wallet address, and a referral system. The backend confirms this is a real issuance-and-payment system, not cosmetics: it exposes stablecoin payment verification by transaction hash, a purchase queue, paid tiers, a real wallet daemon (send/receive), and on-chain USDT/USDC settlement.

Both stores judge the whole ecosystem, and their rules are narrow. Apple 3.1.5 allows crypto wallets only from organization accounts, allows exchange/transaction features only where the developer holds the appropriate local licensing, and requires token offerings to come from approved financial institutions. Apple 3.1.1 requires in-app

purchase for any in-app unlock, which conflicts with selling access via USDC/USDT. Google Play treats exchanges and wallets under its Financial Services policy, requiring documented licensing per market.

Three paths; pick one before building:

- Path A (recommended): ship the arcade as a free branded game, fully severed from the coin. Remove the price, market cap, buy button, signup/wallet/invite. Fastest route, near-zero policy risk.
- Path B: informational companion. Keep price/stats and login, but never buy, sell, send, or receive in-app; all transactions stay on the desktop/website. Defensible but reviewers may still class it as a crypto app.
- Path C: full crypto app. Requires an organization developer account, documented licensing per country, a securities-law review of DGD, and IAP for iOS unlocks. A months-long legal track, not an engineering one.

Content and metadata blockers

Assuming Path A or B:

- Preview watermarks. Nearly every screen reads "PREVIEW / NOT LIVE," the chart says "illustrative," and the home says "coming soon." Apple 4.2 and 2.1 reject placeholder or demo-looking apps. Every shipped feature must be live; remove this language or the features until they work.
- Illustrative financial figures. The price-change tiles, growth curves, and market cap are shown as real performance while a footnote calls them illustrative. Showing invented figures for a financial asset is both a policy and a consumer-protection risk. Display only real, sourced numbers, or drop the financial framing.
- Student/minor gating. Signup requires a .edu address and says "Students only" (backend confirms requiresEduEmail=true). Targeting students, some minors, with a crypto-adjacent product raises Play Families and Apple age-rating scrutiny. Set an honest age rating (not for children) and be ready to justify the targeting.
- Account deletion. The app creates accounts, so both stores require an in-app delete-account flow, not a contact form. The backend has no delete endpoint today (see API gaps).
- Privacy policy and data labels. The app collects email, username, password, and a wallet address. Publish a reachable privacy policy URL, and complete Play Data Safety and Apple Privacy Labels to match what the API collects.

Security note (most urgent item)

The admin Swagger login you shared controls coin prices, wallets, and payouts, and the Swagger UI at `/api/doki/` is currently publicly reachable. Treat that credential as compromised: rotate it now, rotate any keys exposed with it, and restrict or remove public access to the Swagger endpoint in production. This is not a store rule, but it is the highest-priority action in this review.

API: what exists and what is missing

The backend is far more complete than the app uses. Live signup config returned `educationalFunc=true`, `requiresEduEmail=true`, `paymentsPaused=true`.

Exists and usable now (safe for Path B display):

- Stats: `/forms/stats`, `/forms/all-stats` (price, circulating, market cap)
- Analytics: `/analytics/time-report` (1d/7d/30d/365d change) and `/analytics` (historical series). The "live historical data coming soon" chart data already exists.
- Accounts: `/forms/check-username`, `/forms/check-email`, `/forms/send-email-code`, `/forms/verify-email-code`, `/forms/add`, `/forms/login` (JWT), `/forms/user-info`, `/forms/signup-config`
- Referrals/social: `/forms/referral-count` and the meme endpoints
- Wallet/payments (do NOT surface in iOS without Path C compliance): `/forms/purchase-eligibility`, `/forms/new-transaction`, `/payment/verify-by-tx`, the `/usdg/*` wallet RPCs, and `/web3/*` stablecoin checks

Gaps the app needs but the API lacks:

1. Account-deletion endpoint. None exists; store policy requires it. Most important gap.
2. Self-service password reset. Only an admin-side `/forms/internal-change-password` exists; users need email-based reset.
3. Data export, to pair with deletion for GDPR/CCPA.
4. A store-compliant destination for "Get Digital Gold" (on iOS this cannot be an in-app coin purchase).
5. Terms of Service content. `paymentsPaused` is currently true; confirm the intended live state before wiring purchase UI.

Prioritized checklist

Do immediately (security):

- ☐ Rotate the admin password and any keys exposed with it
- ☐ Lock down or remove public access to Swagger at /api/doki/

Decision gate (before building):

- ☐ Choose Path A (game only), B (info companion), or C (full crypto). Recommend A or B near-term

Mechanical (required to submit):

- ☐ Release build, debuggable=false, shrinking on
- ☐ Production upload keystore + Play App Signing; Apple Distribution cert and profile
- ☐ Bump targetSdk to 36
- ☐ Submit an .aab (Play) and an iOS build via App Store Connect
- ☐ Fix version name/code; align app identity (ticker vs arcade)
- ☐ Replace the placeholder id0000000000 App Store link

Content (required for approval):

- ☐ Remove all preview/coming-soon/illustrative content; ship only working features
- ☐ Remove or make real all financial performance figures
- ☐ Add in-app account deletion (needs new API endpoint)
- ☐ Add password reset (needs new API endpoint)
- ☐ Publish privacy policy URL; complete Play Data Safety and Apple Privacy Labels
- ☐ Set an honest age rating; resolve the student/minor question